SALESFORCE ADMIN COURSE — EPISODE 22

Email-to-Case in Salesforce

Automatically Convert Incoming Customer Emails into Tracked Support Cases

- What is Email-to-Case?
- How Case Processing Works
- On-Demand vs. Agent-Based
- Routing Address Configuration
- Address Verification & Testing
- Limits & Recommended Best Practices

EPISODE	DURATION	LEVEL	CORE CLOUD
22 of Series	~19.5 Minutes	Intermediate	Service Cloud

📋 Table of Contents

1. Introduction & Course Context — 0:00 – 0:45
2. What is Email-to-Case & Why Do We Need It? — 0:45 – 4:00
3. How Email-to-Case Works (Email Lifecycle & Threading) — 4:00 – 5:30
4. On-Demand Email-to-Case vs. Agent-Based Email-to-Case — 5:30 – 8:00
5. Prerequisites Checklist — 8:00 – 9:00
6. Enabling Email-to-Case in Salesforce — 9:00 – 10:30
7. Configuring Routing Addresses — 10:30 – 13:00
8. Verifying Routing Address & Live End-to-End Test — 13:00 – 16:00
9. Limitations & Best Practices — 16:00 – 18:30
10. Summary & Key Takeaways — 18:30 – 19:30

SECTION 1

Introduction & Context

⏱ 0:00 – 0:45

Welcome back to the **Salesforce Admin Course!** In the previous episode, we learned how **Web-to-Case** allows customers to report support issues through website forms.

However, many customers prefer sending a direct email instead of visiting a web page and filling in form fields. Do support representatives spend their days manually copying customer emails into Salesforce to open Cases? **Absolutely not!**

Salesforce provides a dedicated, automated communication bridge called **Email-to-Case** that automatically converts incoming emails sent to support inboxes into fully functional Case records.

SECTION 2

What is Email-to-Case & Why Do We Need It?

⏱ 0:45 – 4:00

📱 REAL-WORLD ANALOGY: THE PHONE BATTERY ISSUE

Suppose you purchase a new smartphone and encounter severe battery drain. Rather than navigating to the company portal, you compose an email explaining the problem and send it directly to `support@company.com`. Within seconds, Salesforce receives your email, creates a Case, links your email body and attachments, and assigns it to a technician!

📌 DEFINITION

Email-to-Case is a Salesforce feature that automatically generates Case records whenever an incoming email is delivered to a designated support routing address, while attaching the original email message and future replies to the Case feed.

⚖️ Manual Shared Inboxes vs. Automated Email-to-Case

Aspect	❌ Without Email-to-Case (Shared Inbox)	✅ With Email-to-Case (Salesforce)
Case Creation	Agents manually copy email content and create records	Case created automatically in seconds
Thread Tracking	Scattered email replies; difficult to see who is responding	All incoming and outgoing replies stay threaded in one Case feed
SLA & Visibility	Emails easily get buried, skipped, or forgotten	Clear queues, automated assignment, and measurable response times
Customer Context	Agents must look up customer history in a separate window	Auto-links to existing Contact and Account records

SECTION 3

How Email-to-Case Works (Process Lifecycle)

⏱ 4:00 – 5:30



EMAIL THREADING IN SALESFORCE

Salesforce uses modern **Email Threading tokens** (or legacy Thread IDs) in the email subject and body. When a customer replies to an acknowledgment or agent message, Salesforce checks these identifiers and appends the message to the **existing Case** instead of creating a duplicate!

SECTION 4 — ARCHITECTURE COMPARISON

On-Demand Email-to-Case vs. Agent-Based Email-to-Case

⏱ 5:30 – 8:00

⭐ RECOMMENDED CHOICE

1. On-Demand Email-to-Case

Cloud-native service completely hosted and managed by Salesforce. Requires **zero server installation** or local network maintenance.

- Easiest and fastest setup.
- Salesforce manages server uptime, traffic, and security.
- Handles attachments up to **25 MB** (standard email limit).
- Standard choice for almost all modern businesses.

ENTERPRISE / SPECIALIZED

2. Email-to-Case (Agent-Based)

Requires downloading and running a Java-based open-source **Email-to-Case Agent** inside your company's private network behind your firewall.

- Installed on a dedicated server behind company firewalls.
- Keeps email traffic inside the enterprise local network.
- Can process email attachments larger than **25 MB**.
- High administrative, operational, and maintenance complexity.

Comparison Criterion	On-Demand Email-to-Case	Agent-Based Email-to-Case
Where it Runs	100% in Salesforce Cloud	On customer's on-premises server / VM
Software Installation	None required (point-and-click setup)	Requires local software agent + Java runtime
Max Attachment Size	25 MB (standard email protocol limit)	Larger than 25 MB supported
Maintenance Cost	Low (managed by Salesforce)	High (server patches, monitoring, updates)
Typical Fit	95%+ of all organizations & beginners	Large enterprises with strict firewall policies

SECTIONS 5, 6 & 7 — STEP-BY-STEP HANDS-ON

Enabling Feature & Configuring Routing Address

⏱ 8:00 – 13:00

Part A: Prerequisites

- Active Salesforce Developer, Enterprise, or Sandbox Org with **Case Object** enabled.
- System Administrator permissions.
- A test email address accessible to you (e.g., your Gmail, Outlook, or corporate inbox) to complete verification.

Part B: Enabling Email-to-Case in Setup

1. Click the ⚙ **Setup** gear icon in top right.
2. In the **Quick Find** box, type `Email-to-Case` and select it.
3. Click **Edit**.
4. Check **Enable Email-to-Case**.
5. Check **Enable On-Demand Service**.
6. (Optional) Configure failure notifications to alert admins if an email fails to process.
7. Click **Save**.

Part C: Configuring a Routing Address

1. Under the *Routing Addresses* related list, click **New**.
2. Enter the following essential parameters:
   - **outing Name:** A descriptive name (e.g., `Customer Support Helpdesk`).
   - **mail Address:** Your support address (e.g., `support@yourcompany.com` or your testing email).

- **Case Priority:** Default priority for incoming tickets (e.g., `Medium`).
- **Case Origin:** Set to `Email` to track intake channels accurately.
- **Case Owner:** Assign to a specific user or a **Support Queue** (recommended).

8. Click **Save**.
9. Salesforce displays a notice confirming that a verification email has been dispatched.

SECTIONS 7 & 8 — VERIFICATION & TESTING

Verifying Routing Address & Live End-to-End Test

⏱ 13:00 – 16:00

Step 1: Verify the Address

1. Log into the email inbox associated with the Routing Address you just entered.
2. Open the email sent from `support@salesforce.com` with subject line: *Verify your Salesforce routing address.*
3. Click the provided verification link.
4. Salesforce activates the routing address and generates a unique, long **Salesforce Email Services Address**.

> 💡 **PRODUCTION FORWARDING TIP**
>
> In real production deployments, you create a rule in your email system (Office 365 or Google Workspace) that automatically forwards incoming emails from `support@company.com` to this long Salesforce Email Services Address!

Step 2: Send a Live Test Email

1. Open your personal email account (or any separate inbox).
2. Compose an email addressed to your verified support routing address.
3. Enter a subject: `Mobile Phone Battery Draining Very Fast`
4. Enter body text: *"Hello Support Team, my phone battery drops from 100% to 15% in less than two hours. Please assist."*
5. Click **Send**.

Step 3: Verify the Created Case in Salesforce

1. Return to your Salesforce browser tab.
2. Navigate to **App Launcher → Cases**.

3. Select list view **All Open Cases** or refresh **Recently Viewed**.

4. Open the new Case:
   - Case Subject matches email subject.
   - Case Description contains the email body.
   - Case Origin is set to `Email` .
   - The full email message is visible in the **Activity Feed / Email Related List** ! 🎉

SECTION 9

Limitations & Admin Best Practices

⏱ 16:00 – 18:30

⚠️ Technical Limitations to Keep in Mind

- **Mandatory Verification:** Unverified routing addresses cannot receive or process incoming messages.
- **Formatting Differences:** Rich text, fonts, and inline images depend on how the customer's email client formats outgoing messages.
- **Attachment Size Boundary:** Standard On-Demand Email-to-Case enforces a **25 MB** combined email + attachment threshold.
- **Daily Processing Quotas:** Standard orgs receive a generous daily limit (typically User licenses multiplied by 1,000, up to 1,000,000 emails per day).

💡 Essential Best Practices for Salesforce Admins

- **Use Dedicated Support Inboxes:** Never use personal employee emails; route through dedicated aliases like `billing@`, `techsupport@`, or `help@`.
- **Pair with Case Assignment Rules:** Automatically dispatch incoming cases into distinct Queues based on incoming routing address or keywords.
- **Enable Auto-Response Rules:** Instantly reassure the sender by returning an automated confirmation containing their new Case Number.
- **Preserve Email Threading Tokens:** Keep thread identifiers enabled so all customer follow-up replies attach to the existing Case record.
- **Keep Routing Names Organized:** Maintain clear naming standards for multiple routing lines (e.g., *Tier 1 Support - US*, *Billing Inquiries - EMEA*).
- **Regular Monitoring:** Periodically audit unprocessed email notifications in setup to catch forwarding failures early.

🎯 Key Takeaways from Episode 22

01

Email-to-Case automatically parses incoming customer emails into actionable Case records with attached message history.

02

Eliminates slow manual inbox triage, speeds up first response metrics, and ensures zero lost customer emails.

03

On-Demand Email-to-Case is cloud-hosted and recommended for 95%+ of businesses, requiring zero local software installs.

04

Routing setup requires: Enable feature → Define Routing Address → Complete verification link → Route emails to Salesforce address.

05

Threading tokens ensure all subsequent customer back-and-forth replies stay organized inside the same Case record feed.

06

Combines seamlessly with **Assignment Rules**, **Queues**, and **Auto-Response Rules** for touchless support triage.

COMING UP NEXT — EPISODE 23

Next Core Salesforce Admin Feature

Stay tuned as we continue building practical, job-ready Salesforce administration and automation skills!